

João Duarte (JD)

20+ years working between design and engineering, using research and data to shape products around real user needs. **Hands-on from concept to prototype**, with a strong focus on user testing and product clarity.

FOCUS

Product design, product direction, UX strategy, user research and testing, prototyping, design systems, frontend collaboration, hands-on implementation

EXPERIENCE

BodyVerse : Head of Product Design HANDS-ON

Designed and implemented a Roblox and Roblox Studio tool for game designers to create levels, test the core mechanic, and validate it with real users

Built and lead the in-house art team, including animators and a UI designer, setting visual direction across the game and social media output and establishing the foundation for a broader art function across animation, 3D, and concept work

Led early user research with dancers to understand how performance attributes influence movement, shaping animation and character design direction

Experience LABS : Founder, Product Designer & Engineer

Founded and built a factory-first ecommerce platform that connected storefronts directly to production, inventory, and delivery workflows

Defined the product model, multi-brand design system, and frontend architecture, allowing different brands to run from the same core platform

Designed and implemented key product areas including checkout, PDP, POS, and account tools

Built the platform with React, Next.js, SCSS, and Medusa.js, integrating Stripe and PayFast payments

MADE.com LABS : Head of Product Design HANDS-ON

Co-founded MADE Labs, an innovation team backed by the CTO to explore emerging technology in commerce, including AI, AR, VR, and 3D workflows

Designed and built showroom apps and interactive tools, including real-time moodboards and visual recognition interfaces

Shaped AI-driven concepts to improve personalisation, recommendations, and product discoverability

Worked hands-on across product, design, and engineering, using prototyping to explore direction and de-risk complex ideas

CONTACTS

- [Portfolio : metaphyser.com](https://metaphyser.com)
- metaphyser@gmail.com
- [Linked in](#)
- [GitHub](#)

APR 2024 - PRESENT

- [Company Linked in](#)

JAN 2023 - APR 2024

- [Case Study](#)
[Ecommerce as a System](#)
- [Live Platform](#)
scoochliving.com
- [Company Website](#)

JAN 2019 - NOV 2022

- [Case study: Showroom Screens](#)
- [Case study: 3D Viewer \(AR\)](#)

EXPERIENCE (2019 - 2002)

MADE.com : Head of UX

HANDS-ON

Built and led the UX team at MADE.com

Introduced a UX process for product design, bringing discovery, user research, and usability testing into the way products were shaped

Led the redesign of MADE.com's purchase experience across mobile and web, including checkout, PDPs, and listing pages

Product ML : Principal Product Designer

Defined the UX strategy and product direction for an ML platform focused on player experience

Identified product teams as the core users through UX research and interviews, and shaped the MVP scope. Designed the core product around levers, experiments, and model performance

Plumbee / GSN : Lead Product Designer

Led UX and feature design across live products at Plumbee and GSN

Redesigned GSN Classic Casino through a modular rollout, breaking features into independent updates with fallbacks to the existing UI for long-time users

Owned the full design process for major features including lobby, tournaments, challenges, jackpots, and promotional popups, from research and flows to wireframes, storyboards, prototypes, UI, and animation

TAP Portugal : Principal Product Designer

Worked across the main customer app, the web purchase flow, and operational tools for aircraft cargo logistics and uniform management

Accedo Agency : Lead Product Designer & Engineer

Designed digital products and interactive experiences for clients including Coca-Cola, Seat, Sumol, and Vodafone

Progressed from UX, UI, and motion design into product design leadership. Led creative direction across projects, including team management, while staying closely involved in design and delivery

Junior to Senior : Product Designer & Engineer

Started at SIC, later founded Interferência, and also worked with Toxik Creative School and Bloom Graphics.

TOOLS

Design: Figma, Unity, Blender, 3ds Max, Adobe Creative Suite, Roblox Studio. **Code:** TypeScript, JavaScript, React, Next.js, Three.js, Medusa.js, GraphQL, REST, Node.js, SCSS, HTML, AWS, C#, Python, Lua. **Methods:** User research, usability testing, A/B testing, prototyping, interaction design, journey mapping, behavioural design, motion design, heatmaps and click tracking.

JAN 2018 - JAN 2019

- [Case Study](#)
[Configurable Products at Scale](#)

MAY 2017 - JAN 2018

- [Case Study](#)
[ML for Player Experience](#)

AUG 2014 - MAY 2017

- [Plumbee/GSN work](#)

APR 2014 - AUG 2014

JAN 2010 - JAN 2014

- [Agency Showreel 2011](#)

JAN 2002 - JAN 2009